

2011 NBA Finals

The **2011 NBA Finals** was the championship series of the National Basketball Association's (NBA) 2010–11 season, and the conclusion of the season's playoffs. A rematch of the 2006 Finals, the series was contested between the Western Conference champion Dallas Mavericks and the Eastern Conference champion Miami Heat. It was held from May 31 to June 12, 2011.

Entering the series as heavy favorites due to their new-formed "superteam" of LeBron James, Dwyane Wade, and Chris Bosh,^{[3][4]} the Miami Heat won the opening game and eventually led the series 2–1 before the underdog Dallas Mavericks won the next three games to achieve their first championship in franchise history. Mavericks forward and German player Dirk Nowitzki was named Finals MVP, becoming the second European to win the award after Tony Parker in 2007, and the first German player to do so.^[5] Due to Nowitzki's overcoming the heavily-favored superteam despite his previous turbulent playoff history and as the only star player on an aging squad, the series has been acclaimed as one of the greatest finals of all time.^{[6][7][8]}

Background

Both the Mavericks and Heat made their second appearance in the NBA Finals, the first for both teams being the 2006 NBA Finals. This Finals marked a rematch of those 2006 Finals, won by Miami in six games, after the Mavericks were up 2–0.^[9]

It was also the first time since 2006 that neither the Los Angeles Lakers nor the San Antonio Spurs represented the Western Conference in the Finals and only the second time since 1998, and also the thirteenth consecutive NBA Finals to feature a Western Conference champion from either the states of California or Texas.

This was the first finals since 1998 not to feature Kobe Bryant (2000–2002, 2004, 2008–2010), Shaquille O'Neal (2000–2002, 2004, 2006) or Tim Duncan (1999, 2003, 2005, 2007).

The Mavericks' appearance also meant that three of North America's four major professional sports championships were played in the Dallas–Fort Worth metroplex in a span of eight months, with the 2010 World Series and Super Bowl XLV both occurring in nearby Arlington.^[10]

The Heat had home-court advantage by virtue of a better regular-season record than the Mavericks. This was only the second time that the Eastern Conference had home-court advantage during the Finals since the end of the Michael Jordan era in 1998. It also marks the first time since 1995 that the Eastern Conference team lost in the Finals despite having home-court advantage.

The 2011 series marked the first time a Finals match (Game 1) was played in the month of May since 1986.

Among the players from both teams, only Dirk Nowitzki and Jason Terry of Dallas, and Dwyane Wade and Udonis Haslem of Miami, appeared in the 2006 series with the same team. Heat center Erick Dampier played for the Mavericks in 2006. Aside from Dampier, Caron Butler, Juwan Howard, and Shawn Marion are the only other players who have played for both the Mavericks and Heat. Eddie House, Žydrūnas Ilgauskas, LeBron James (James would reach the finals every year from 2011 to 2018, with both the Heat and the Cavaliers), and Jason Kidd have appeared in the Finals with different teams, with House (as a member of Boston's 2008 championship team), Wade and Haslem winning a championship ring. Mavericks head coach Rick Carlisle won a championship as a reserve for Boston's 1986 championship team making him only the eleventh person in NBA history to win a Finals as both a player and a coach.

Prior to the start of the season, Jason Terry tattooed the Larry O'Brien Championship Trophy on his right biceps, anticipating the Mavericks would be champions this season.^[11]

2011 NBA Finals		
		
Team	Coach	Wins
Dallas Mavericks	Rick Carlisle	4
Miami Heat	Erik Spoelstra	2
Dates	May 31 – June 12	
MVP	Dirk Nowitzki (Dallas Mavericks)^{[1][2]}	
Hall of Famers	Mavericks: Jason Kidd (2018) Dirk Nowitzki (2023) Heat: Chris Bosh (2021) Dwyane Wade (2023) Officials: Danny Crawford (2025)	
Eastern finals	Heat defeated Bulls, 4–1	
Western finals	Mavericks defeated Thunder, 4–1	

Road to the Finals

Dallas Mavericks (Western Conference champion)							Miami Heat (Eastern Conference champion)					
#	Western Conference					Regular season	#	Eastern Conference				
	Team	W	L	PCT	GB			Team	W	L	PCT	GB
1	c-San Antonio Spurs	61	21	.744	–		1	z-Chicago Bulls	62	20	.756	–
2	y-Los Angeles Lakers	57	25	.695	4		2	y-Miami Heat	58	24	.707	4
3	x-Dallas Mavericks	57	25	.695	4		3	y-Boston Celtics	56	26	.683	6
4	y-Oklahoma City Thunder	55	27	.671	6		4	x-Orlando Magic	52	30	.634	10
5	x-Denver Nuggets	50	32	.610	11		5	x-Atlanta Hawks	44	38	.537	18
6	x-Portland Trail Blazers	48	34	.585	13		6	x-New York Knicks	42	40	.512	20
7	x-New Orleans Hornets	46	36	.561	15		7	x-Philadelphia 76ers	41	41	.500	21
8	x-Memphis Grizzlies	46	36	.561	15		8	x-Indiana Pacers	37	45	.451	25
9	Houston Rockets	43	39	.524	18		9	Milwaukee Bucks	35	47	.427	27
10	Phoenix Suns	40	42	.488	21		10	Charlotte Bobcats	34	48	.415	28
11	Utah Jazz	39	43	.476	22		11	Detroit Pistons	30	52	.366	32
12	Golden State Warriors	36	46	.439	25		12	New Jersey Nets	24	58	.293	38
13	Los Angeles Clippers	32	50	.390	29		13	Washington Wizards	23	59	.280	39
14	Sacramento Kings	24	58	.293	37		14	Toronto Raptors	22	60	.268	40
15	Minnesota Timberwolves	17	65	.207	44		15	Cleveland Cavaliers	19	63	.232	43
3rd seed in the West, 5th-best league record							2nd seed in the East, 3rd-best league record					
Defeated the 6th-seeded <u>Portland Trail Blazers</u> , 4–2						First round	Defeated the 7th-seeded <u>Philadelphia 76ers</u> , 4–1					
Defeated the 2nd-seeded <u>Los Angeles Lakers</u> , 4–0						Conference semifinals	Defeated the 3rd-seeded <u>Boston Celtics</u> , 4–1					
Defeated the 4th-seeded <u>Oklahoma City Thunder</u> , 4–1						Conference finals	Defeated the 1st-seeded <u>Chicago Bulls</u> , 4–1					

Regular-season series

The Dallas Mavericks won both games in the regular season.

November 27, 2010	Recap (http://www.nba.com/games/20101127/MIADAL/#/recap)	Miami Heat 95, Dallas Mavericks 106	American Airlines Center, <u>Dallas, Texas</u>
December 20, 2010	Recap (http://www.nba.com/games/20101220/DALMIA/#/recap)	Dallas Mavericks 98, <u>Miami Heat</u> 96	American Airlines Arena, <u>Miami, Florida</u>

Series summary

Game	Date	Road team	Result	Home team
Game 1	May 31	Dallas Mavericks	84–92 (0–1)	Miami Heat
Game 2	June 2	Dallas Mavericks	95–93 (1–1)	Miami Heat
Game 3	June 5	Miami Heat	88–86 (2–1)	Dallas Mavericks
Game 4	June 7	Miami Heat	83–86 (2–2)	Dallas Mavericks
Game 5	June 9	Miami Heat	103–112 (2–3)	Dallas Mavericks
Game 6	June 12	Dallas Mavericks	105–95 (4–2)	Miami Heat

Game summaries

All times are in Eastern Daylight Time (UTC−4).

Game 1

May 31 9:00 pm	Recap with video (http://www.nba.com/games/20110531/DALMIA/gameinfo.html)	Dallas Mavericks 84, Miami Heat 92 Scoring by quarter: 17–16, 27–27, 17–22, 23–27 Pts: Dirk Nowitzki 27 Pts: LeBron James 24 Rebs: Shawn Marion 10 Rebs: Dwyane Wade 10 Asts: Jason Kidd 6 Asts: Dwyane Wade 6 Miami leads series, 1–0	American Airlines Arena, Miami, Florida Attendance: 20,003 Referees: Steve Javie, Mike Callahan, Bill Kennedy	ABC
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Game 1 was the first NBA Finals game to be held in the month of May since 1986. The Heat made only 28.6 percent of their shots during the first quarter, and this low scoring percentage early on left the Mavs with an 8-point lead early into the 3rd quarter. The Heat changed course from this point on, outscoring the Mavs 22–10 and taking a 65–61 lead going into the 4th quarter. Mavs power forward Dirk Nowitzki injured his finger within the last four minutes of the game, but remained in play, wearing a splint to support the torn tendon.^[12] Despite having a below-average performance early in the game, Heat shooting guard Dwyane Wade and small forward LeBron James collaborated on both defensive and offensive ends of the court in the fourth quarter, leading the Heat to win Game 1 over the Mavs 92–84.^[13]

Game 2

June 2 9:00 pm	Recap with video (http://www.nba.com/games/20110602/DALMIA/gameinfo.html)	Dallas Mavericks 95, Miami Heat 93 Scoring by quarter: 28–28, 23–23, 20–24, 24–18 Pts: Dirk Nowitzki 24 Pts: Dwyane Wade 36 Rebs: Dirk Nowitzki 11 Rebs: James, Bosh 8 each Asts: Kidd, Terry 5 each Asts: Dwyane Wade 6 Series tied, 1–1	American Airlines Arena, Miami, Florida Attendance: 20,003 Referees: Joe Crawford, Ed Malloy, Ken Mauer	ABC
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The Mavs' 15-point comeback was the biggest in an NBA Finals game since the 24-point comeback the Celtics made against the Lakers in Game 4 of the 2008 NBA Finals.^[14] Dirk Nowitzki hit a 3 with 26.7 seconds left to give the Mavericks a 93–90 lead. However, Mario Chalmers tied it with a 3 of his own with 24.5 seconds left when Jason Terry left him wide open. After Jason Kidd ran the clock down, Nowitzki then made a driving layup with his injured left hand with 3.6 seconds left. The Heat had no timeouts left, and Dwyane Wade's potential game-winning 3 hit the back rim at the buzzer as he fell to the ground in an attempt to draw a foul on Nowitzki.^[15] The Mavs' win broke the Heat's 9-game home winning streak in the playoffs, costing them a chance to tie the 1996 Bulls' mark of 10 straight. This was the second straight Finals with a 1–1 split after two games, after five straight years with one team leading 2–0 (2005–09).

External videos

 Full game broadcast by ABC (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bWTVcZjQx3c>) on YouTube

Game 3

June 5 8:00 pm	Recap with video (http://www.nba.com/games/20110605/MIADAL/gameinfo.html)	Miami Heat 88, Dallas Mavericks 86 Scoring by quarter: 29–22, 18–20, 20–22, 21–22 Pts: Dwyane Wade 29 Pts: Dirk Nowitzki 34 Rebs: Dwyane Wade 11 Rebs: Chandler, Nowitzki 11 each Asts: LeBron James 9 Asts: Jason Kidd 10 Miami leads series, 2–1	American Airlines Center, Dallas, Texas Attendance: 20,340 Referees: Danny Crawford, Scott Foster, Derrick Stafford	ABC
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The Heat led most of the game, but the Mavericks fought back from a 14-point deficit. With 39.6 seconds left in the 4th, LeBron James found Chris Bosh for a 20-foot baseline jumper; Dirk Nowitzki had a chance to force OT, but missed a well-defended fadeaway jumper at the buzzer as the Heat handed Dallas another defeat to go up 2–1 in the series.^[16] It was Miami's sixth win in its last seven NBA Finals games, four by 3 points or less.

Game 4

June 7 9:00 pm	Recap with video (http://www.nba.com/games/20110607/MIADAL/gameinfo.html)	Miami Heat 83, Dallas Mavericks 86 Scoring by quarter: 21–21, 26–24, 22–20, 14–21 Pts: Dwyane Wade 32 Pts: Dirk Nowitzki 21 Rebs: LeBron James 9 Rebs: Tyson Chandler 16 Asts: LeBron James 7 Asts: José Juan Barea 4 Series tied, 2–2	American Airlines Center, Dallas, Texas Attendance: 20,430 Referees: Monty McCutchen, Marc Davis, Greg Willard	ABC
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Nowitzki was questionable for the game with a flu.^[17]

Game 4 was a back-and-forth affair, with 12 lead changes and 15 ties. Miami went up 74–65 early in the fourth quarter on a baseline jumpshot by Udonis Haslem, tallying their largest lead of the game. After a timeout, Dallas answered with 4 straight points by Jason Terry, similar to the 6 straight he scored with Dallas down 15 halfway through the fourth quarter of Game 2. Dallas would take their first lead of the fourth quarter with 5:15 left on a fastbreak layup by Terry. They held the lead for the rest of the game, although Miami cut the lead to 1 twice in the final minute. Up 82–81 with 20 seconds left after Dwyane Wade missed 1 of 2 free throws, Dirk Nowitzki hit a driving layup with 14.4 seconds left to extend the lead to 3. After a dunk by Wade with 9 seconds left, 2 free throws by Terry pushed the lead back up to 3. With a chance to tie the game with a 3, Wade fumbled the inbounds pass with 6.7 seconds left, only to make a diving save to prevent a backcourt violation. The ball landed in Mike Miller's hands, whose desperation 3 airballed at the buzzer, preserving Dallas' 86–83 win.^[18] LeBron James scored just 8 total points in Game 4 on 3-11 (27.2%) shooting, including going 0-6 from the field when guarded by Jason Kidd or Jason Terry, but still led his team with 9 rebounds and 7 assists.

Game 5

June 9 9:00 pm	Recap with video (h ttp://ww w.nba.c om/gam es/2011 0609/MI ADAL/g ameinf o.html)	Miami Heat 103, Dallas Mavericks 112 Scoring by quarter: 31–30, 26–30, 22–24, 24–28 Pts: Dwyane Wade 23 Rebs: James, Bosh 10 each Asts: LeBron James 10	Pts: Dirk Nowitzki 29 Rebs: Tyson Chandler 7 Asts: Kidd, Terry 6 each Dallas leads series, 3–2	American Airlines Center, Dallas, Texas Attendance: 20,433 Referees: Joe Crawford, Mike Callahan, Bill Kennedy	ABC
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After pre-game walkthroughs, LeBron James and Dwyane Wade mocked Nowitzki with fake coughs, as they felt like he was "faking" his reported flu;^[19] years later, Wade acknowledged the incident was a childish in an interview with Nowitzki.^[20]

After four low-scoring games, Game 5 saw the first time either team would break 100 points in this series. Dallas connected 13 times out of their 19 tries from three-point range. Jason Terry, Jason Kidd, and J. J. Barea combined to make 10 of those 13 made threes. Late in the first quarter, Dwyane Wade ran into Brian Cardinal and had to go to the locker room with a hip injury; he eventually returned and hit a 3 to cap a 9–0 run that put Miami in front 99–95 with less than 5 minutes left in the game. Unhappy with Terry for missing a defensive assignment and setting a poor cross-screen, Mavs coach Rick Carlisle pulled Terry from the game, telling him, "Refocus. I'm putting you right back in."^[21] After less than a minute, Carlisle subbed in Terry and made the crucial decision to run the offense through him for the rest of the game. This move ignited Dallas' offense, leading them on a game-winning 15–3 run in which Terry scored or assisted on 11 points. With Miami leading 100–97, Terry passed to Dirk Nowitzki, who drew a double team and then kicked it back out to Terry for a game-tying 3. Nowitzki then drove baseline on Chris Bosh for a two-handed dunk (assisted by Terry) with 2:44 left in the game to give the Mavs a 102–100 lead they would not relinquish. After LeBron James was called for an offensive foul (Tyson Chandler drew the charge), Terry found Kidd for another wide-open 3 that gave the Mavs a 105–100 lead with 1:26 left. After Chandler blocked Wade with 1:04 left, Bosh made 1 of 2 free throws to cut the Mavs' lead to 105–101. On the Mavs' next possession, Terry knocked down a 28-foot three-pointer with James closely guarding him to give the Mavs an insurmountable 108–101 lead with 33.3 seconds left. The Mavericks won 112–103 and grabbed a 3–2 series lead going back to Miami.^[22]

Game 6

June 12 8:00 pm	Recap with video (h ttp://ww w.nba.c om/gam es/2011 0612/D ALMIA/ gameinf o.html)	Dallas Mavericks 105, Miami Heat 95 Scoring by quarter: 32–27, 21–24, 28–21, 24–23 Pts: Jason Terry 27 Rebs: Dirk Nowitzki 11 Asts: Jason Kidd 8	Pts: LeBron James 21 Rebs: Udonis Haslem 9 Asts: Mario Chalmers 7 Dallas wins NBA Finals, 4–2	American Airlines Arena, Miami, Florida Attendance: 20,003 Referees: Steve Javie, Scott Foster, Derrick Stafford	ABC
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LeBron James made his first four shots to contribute to the Heat taking a 20–11 lead. The Mavericks went to a zone defense that perplexed Miami and Dallas went on a 21–4 run in a span of 5½ minutes. They made 9 of 12 shots during this stretch with DeShawn Stevenson making three-pointers in a 24-second duration to give Dallas a 40–28 lead with 9:42 left in the first half. Dallas turned Miami's first six turnovers into 14 points. The Heat then went on a 14–0 run to take a 42–40 lead. With 6:25 left in the half, Stevenson along with Udonis Haslem and Mario Chalmers received technical fouls after a scuffle occurred at midcourt during a timeout. In the second half, James did not score until making a layup with 1:49 remaining in the third. The Mavericks led by nine going into the 4th quarter after Ian Mahinmi hit a buzzer beater to give Dallas an 81–72 lead. The Mavericks took a 12-point lead with 8:12 remaining. With 2:27 left, Nowitzki made a jump shot to help build the Mavericks' lead to 99–89. The Mavericks, who led for the final 22 minutes in the game, won their first championship in franchise history.^[23] Nowitzki was named Finals MVP.^{[24][25]} He had a poor shooting performance in the first half but managed to score 18 points in the second half.^{[5][26]} When the final buzzer sounded, an emotional Nowitzki went straight to the locker room in tears, although he re-emerged for the trophy presentation.

Rosters

Dallas Mavericks

2010–11 Dallas Mavericks roster									
Players									Coaches
Pos. ♦	No. ♦	Player	Height	Weight	DOB	From	Head coach		
PG	11	J. J. Barea	5 ft 10 in (1.78 m)	185 lb (84 kg)	1984–06–26	Northeastern	▪ Rick Carlisle ▪ Assistant(s) ▪ Darrell Armstrong ▪ Dwane Casey ▪ Monte Mathis ▪ Robert Hackett ▪ Terry Stotts		
PG	3	Rodrigue Beaubois	6 ft 0 in (1.83 m)	170 lb (77 kg)	1988–02–24	France			
F	13	Corey Brewer	6 ft 9 in (2.06 m)	186 lb (84 kg)	1986–03–05	Florida			
F	4	Caron Butler	6 ft 7 in (2.01 m)	228 lb (103 kg)	1980–03–13	Connecticut			
F	35	Brian Cardinal	6 ft 8 in (2.03 m)	245 lb (111 kg)	1977–05–02	Purdue			
C	6	Tyson Chandler	7 ft 1 in (2.16 m)	240 lb (109 kg)	1982–10–02	Dominguez HS (California)			
C	33	Brendan Haywood	7 ft 0 in (2.13 m)	268 lb (122 kg)	1979–11–27	North Carolina	Legend ▪ (DP) Unsigned draft pick ▪ (FA) Free agent ▪ (S) Suspended ▪ + Injured		
G	20	Dominique Jones	6 ft 4 in (1.93 m)	215 lb (98 kg)	1988–10–15	South Florida			
PG	2	Jason Kidd	6 ft 4 in (1.93 m)	205 lb (93 kg)	1973–03–23	California			
C	28	Ian Mahinmi	6 ft 11 in (2.11 m)	262 lb (119 kg)	1986–11–05	France			
F	0	Shawn Marion	6 ft 7 in (2.01 m)	220 lb (100 kg)	1978–05–07	UNLV			
PF	41	Dirk Nowitzki	7 ft 0 in (2.13 m)	245 lb (111 kg)	1978–06–19	Germany			
G	92	DeShawn Stevenson	6 ft 5 in (1.96 m)	210 lb (95 kg)	1981–04–03	Washington Union HS (California)			
SF	16	Peja Stojaković	6 ft 10 in (2.08 m)	229 lb (104 kg)	1977–06–09	Serbia			
G	31	Jason Terry	6 ft 2 in (1.88 m)	185 lb (84 kg)	1977–09–15	Arizona			

Miami Heat

2010–11 Miami Heat roster									
Players									Coaches
Pos. ♦	No. ♦	Player	Height	Weight	DOB	From	Head coach		
C	50	Joel Anthony	6 ft 9 in (2.06 m)	245 lb (111 kg)	1982–08–09	UNLV	▪ Erik Spoelstra ▪ Assistant(s) ▪ Keith Askins ▪ David Fizdale ▪ Bill Foran ▪ Chet Kammerer ▪ Bob McAdoo ▪ Ron Rothstein		
G	0	Mike Bibby	6 ft 2 in (1.88 m)	195 lb (88 kg)	1978–05–13	Arizona			
F	1	Chris Bosh	6 ft 11 in (2.11 m)	230 lb (104 kg)	1984–03–24	Georgia Tech			
G	15	Mario Chalmers	6 ft 2 in (1.88 m)	195 lb (88 kg)	1986–05–19	Kansas			
C	25	Erick Dampier	6 ft 11 in (2.11 m)	265 lb (120 kg)	1975–07–14	Mississippi State			
F	40	Udonis Haslem	6 ft 8 in (2.03 m)	235 lb (107 kg)	1980–06–09	Florida			
G	55	Eddie House	6 ft 1 in (1.85 m)	178 lb (81 kg)	1978–05–14	Arizona State	Legend ▪ (DP) Unsigned draft pick ▪ (FA) Free agent ▪ (S) Suspended ▪ + Injured		
F	5	Juwan Howard	6 ft 9 in (2.06 m)	253 lb (115 kg)	1973–02–07	Michigan			
C	11	Žydrūnas Ilgauskas	7 ft 3 in (2.21 m)	260 lb (118 kg)	1975–06–05	Lithuania			
F	6	LeBron James	6 ft 8 in (2.03 m)	250 lb (113 kg)	1984–12–30	St. Vincent – St. Mary HS (Ohio)			
F	22	James Jones	6 ft 8 in (2.03 m)	215 lb (98 kg)	1980–10–04	Miami (FL)			
C	21	Jamaal Magloire	6 ft 11 in (2.11 m)	255 lb (116 kg)	1978–05–21	Kentucky			

Pos.	No.	Player	Height	Weight	DOB	From
F	13	Mike Miller	6 ft 8 in (2.03 m)	218 lb (99 kg)	1980-02-19	Florida
C	45	Dexter Pittman	6 ft 10 in (2.08 m)	290 lb (132 kg)	1988-03-02	Texas
G	3	Dwyane Wade	6 ft 4 in (1.93 m)	220 lb (100 kg)	1982-01-17	Marquette

Player statistics

Legend					
GP	Games played	GS	Games started	MPG	Minutes per game
FG%	Field-goal percentage	3P%	3-point field-goal percentage	FT%	Free-throw percentage
RPG	Rebounds per game	APG	Assists per game	SPG	Steals per game
BPG	Blocks per game	PPG	Points per game		

Dallas Mavericks

Dallas Mavericks statistics											
Player	GP	GS	MPG	FG%	3P%	FT%	RPG	APG	SPG	BPG	PPG
José Juan Barea	6	3	21.4	.382	.333	.714	2.2	3.2	0.5	0.0	8.8
Brian Cardinal	5	0	6.1	.667	.667	.500	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.0	1.4
Tyson Chandler	6	6	37.3	.594	.000	.625	8.8	0.7	1.2	1.2	9.7
Brendan Haywood	3	0	8.5	.333	.000	.500	2.3	0.0	0.3	1.0	1.7
Jason Kidd	6	6	37.4	.389	.429	.750	4.5	6.3	1.2	0.8	7.7
Ian Mahinmi	3	0	9.0	.600	.000	.600	1.7	0.0	0.3	0.0	3.0
Shawn Marion	6	6	35.8	.479	.000	.824	6.3	2.3	0.8	0.7	13.7
Dirk Nowitzki	6	6	40.4	.416	.368	.978	9.7	2.0	0.7	0.7	26.0
DeShawn Stevenson	6	3	17.2	.542	.565	.750	1.5	0.3	0.7	0.2	7.0
Peja Stojaković	4	0	6.4	.200	.000	.000	0.8	0.0	0.5	0.0	0.5
Jason Terry	6	0	32.6	.494	.393	.750	2.0	3.2	1.3	0.0	18.0

Miami Heat

Miami Heat statistics											
Player	GP	GS	MPG	FG%	3P%	FT%	RPG	APG	SPG	BPG	PPG
Joel Anthony	6	6	20.6	.286	.000	.000	3.5	0.3	0.2	1.2	1.3
Mike Bibby	5	5	17.4	.350	.294	.000	1.4	1.0	1.4	0.2	3.8
Chris Bosh	6	6	39.4	.413	.000	.778	7.3	1.0	0.2	0.5	18.5
Mario Chalmers	6	1	28.9	.426	.400	.739	2.7	3.5	1.7	0.0	11.8
Udonis Haslem	6	0	29.4	.450	.000	.800	5.2	0.7	0.5	0.5	6.7
Eddie House	2	0	12.3	.333	.375	.000	2.0	0.5	1.0	0.0	4.5
Juwan Howard	5	0	5.9	.600	.000	.500	1.2	0.2	0.0	0.0	1.8
LeBron James	6	6	43.6	.478	.321	.600	7.2	6.8	1.7	0.5	17.8
Mike Miller	6	0	15.6	.304	.389	.000	2.8	0.8	0.8	0.2	3.5
Dwyane Wade	6	6	39.0	.546	.304	.694	7.0	5.2	1.5	1.5	26.5

Broadcast notes

The Finals were originally projected to begin on Thursday, June 9, but (along with the entire NBA schedule) were pushed up ahead one week to Thursday, June 2 due to negotiations on an impending league-wide lockout at the end of the season.^[27] They were again pushed ahead to a start date of May 31 as both conference finals series ended in five games.

The Finals were televised in the United States through ABC (which included the respective Miami and Dallas affiliates WPLG and WFAA), with Mike Breen, Mark Jackson and Jeff Van Gundy as announcers. Doris Burke was the sideline reporter, while Stuart Scott hosted the championship presentation. Scott also hosted the pre-game and halftime shows along with Jon Barry, Michael Wilbon, and Magic Johnson. ESPN Radio aired the Finals nationally on radio, with Mike Tirico, Hubie Brown, and Jack Ramsay announcing.

Until 2014, this is the last Finals to be called entirely by Breen, Van Gundy, and Jackson altogether.

Game	Ratings (households)	Share (households)	American audience (in millions)
1 ^[28]	9.0	15	15.171
2 ^[28]	9.3	16	15.522
3 ^[28]	9.1	15	15.338
4 ^[29]	9.6	16	16.126
5 ^[29]	10.8	19	18.318
6 ^[29]	13.3	22	23.880

Aftermath



President Barack Obama meeting Jason Kidd, Jason Terry, and Dirk Nowitzki at the Mavericks White House visit in 2012.

The 2011 edition of the NBA Finals is considered one of the best ever, although it is often overshadowed by the two other great Finals in the decade (2013 and 2016).^[30] From the 2011–2019 NBA Finals, [LeBron James](#) or [Stephen Curry](#) would participate each one, similar to how [Shaquille O'Neal](#), [Kobe Bryant](#) and [Tim Duncan](#) accomplished this feat from the 1999–2010 NBA Finals.^[31]

[LeBron James](#) was criticized heavily for his performance in the Finals.^{[32][33][34][35][36][37]} James averaged 17.8 points, 7.2 rebounds and 6.8 assists in the 6 games (all well below his season averages), culminating in just an 8 point, 7 assist, 9 rebound performance in a pivotal Game 4 (the Heat would lose this game and the final 2). James was often guarded by smaller players, such as [Jason Terry](#), [Jason Kidd](#), and [J.J. Barea](#), and [DeShawn Stevenson](#), yet could not take advantage of these mismatches.^[38] In 2024, James would call the 2011 Finals the lowest point of his career.^[39] James and the Heat quickly rebounded, winning the next two NBA Finals (2012, 2013).^[40]

2011 represented a high point for the Mavericks and franchise player [Dirk Nowitzki](#). Before 2011, the Mavericks had not come away with a [Larry O'Brien trophy](#) after 10 straight postseason trips. Much of the criticism was placed at the feet of Nowitzki, the team's best player. However, in 2011, it would all come together, with the Mavericks championship run being considered as one of the toughest in NBA history, along with the 1969 [Celtics](#) and 1995 [Rockets](#).^[41] In the 2011 playoffs, the Mavs survived a scare from the [Trail Blazers](#) in the first round, handily swept the defending champion [Lakers](#) in the second round, and dispatched the upstart [Thunder](#) in the Western Conference finals. From there, they pulled off one of the biggest upsets in the NBA Finals history by defeating the [Big Three](#) Miami Heat. The Mavs did not have the home-court advantage in any of the last three rounds. On the run to the Finals, Nowitzki also ended the narrative as a playoff under-performer, as he tied the record for most made FGs to tie/take the lead in the last 90 seconds of the 4th/OT in one playoffs (since the play-by-play era in 1997) with 5.^[42]

In the summer, team owner [Mark Cuban](#) elected not to re-sign center and defensive anchor [Tyson Chandler](#).^[43] They also lost top defensive assistant coach coach [Dwane Casey](#) to the Toronto Raptors. These losses severely hurt the team's defense the following season, as fell to 7th place in the conference during the lockout shortened season. Overall, after the championship, the Mavericks made the playoff four of the next five seasons, but they did not win any round. Nowitzki retired in 2019, with the 2011 NBA Finals being the last playoff series he won.

Like he did prior to the Mavericks championship season in 2010–2011, two years later, prior to the 2012–13 season, Jason Terry, by then with the Boston Celtics, tattooed the Celtics' famous leprechaun spinning the Larry O'Brien trophy on his finger on his left arm.^[44] However, the Celtics did not win the championship that season.

Jason Kidd would later coach [LeBron James](#) as an assistant coach during the 2019–2020 Los Angeles [Lakers](#) season. Kidd became the head coach for the Mavs in 2021 after [Rick Carlisle](#) mutually parted ways with the team.^[45]

The Championship won by the Mavericks would be the first for the [Dallas-Fort Worth Metroplex](#), since the [Dallas Stars](#) won the [Stanley Cup](#) in 1999 and the last until the [Texas Rangers](#) defeated the [Arizona Diamondbacks](#) in the [World Series](#) in 2023. The Mavericks would return to the Finals again in 2024 but fell to the [Boston Celtics](#) in five games.

In Popular Culture

In Puerto Rican rapper [Bad Bunny](#)'s 2022 song [El Apagón](#), he shouts out fellow Puerto Rican [J. J. Barea](#) while taking a small diss at [LeBron James](#): "Y de Barea, el que fue campeón primero que Lebron" which translates to "And Barea, the one who was a champion before LeBron". This was in reference to Dallas win over Miami in 2011, which allowed Barea to win a championship before James.



Owner Mark Cuban at the Mavericks championship parade

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